



PHISHING EMAIL

DETECTION & AWARENESS REPORT

A Technical Cybersecurity Analysis Submitted for Internship Evaluation

ORGANIZATION

Future Interns

INTERNSHIP PROGRAM

Cyber Security Internship — Task 2 (2026)

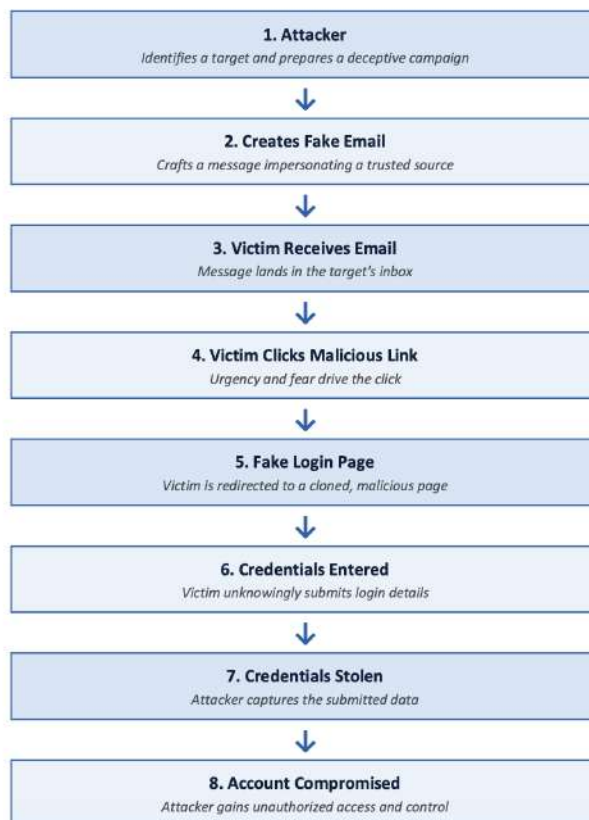
Prepared By

Pratyush Singh Rathore

July 2026

10. How a Phishing Attack Works

The diagram below illustrates the typical lifecycle of a phishing attack, from initial creation to full account compromise.



6. Detailed Email Analysis

6.1 Subject Line Analysis

The subject line, "Urgent: Your Account Will Be Locked," is deliberately engineered to provoke an immediate emotional response. The words 'Urgent' and 'Account Will Be Locked' function as psychological triggers, designed to bypass rational evaluation by inducing panic. This tactic pressures the recipient into acting quickly — clicking the link — before pausing to verify the email's authenticity.

6.2 Greeting Analysis

The email opens with the generic greeting "Dear User," rather than addressing the recipient by their registered name. Legitimate organizations, particularly banks and service providers, typically personalize customer communications using account-holder names. The use of a generic greeting strongly suggests that this message was sent as part of a mass phishing campaign rather than genuine, individualized correspondence.

6.3 Message Body Analysis

The message body is intentionally vague, referencing "suspicious activity" without providing any specific, verifiable details such as timestamps, device information, or geographic location. This lack of evidence is a hallmark of phishing communication — legitimate security alerts typically include specific, checkable information. The absence of detail, combined with an alarming tone, is designed to create fear while avoiding any information that could be independently verified or disproven.

6.4 URL Analysis

The embedded link, [http://secure-account-verify\[.\]com](http://secure-account-verify[.]com), exhibits multiple red flags upon inspection:

- **Suspicious Domain:** The domain name mimics legitimate account-verification language but is not associated with any recognized, official organization.
- **Unofficial Website:** The domain structure does not match any known legitimate service provider's official domain.
- **Use of HTTP Instead of HTTPS:** The link uses the insecure HTTP protocol rather than HTTPS, indicating the absence of a valid SSL/TLS certificate — a major red flag for any page requesting credentials.
- **Credential Theft Risk:** The URL is highly likely to lead to a fake login page designed to harvest usernames and passwords.
- **Should Never Be Visited:** Given the above indicators, this URL should be treated as malicious and must never be accessed, even for testing purposes, outside of an isolated and controlled analysis environment.

6.5 Psychological Manipulation Techniques

This email employs several well-documented social engineering techniques:

- **Fear:** Suggesting account compromise to provoke anxiety.
- **Urgency:** Demanding immediate action within a strict 24-hour window.
- **Time Pressure:** Reducing the recipient's opportunity for careful evaluation.
- **Social Engineering:** Exploiting trust in the guise of an official 'Security Team.'
- **Emotional Manipulation:** Framing inaction as leading to a negative, permanent consequence (account lock).